

POLICY ON SCHOLARSHIPS AND DISCOUNTS

Rationale

The University of Mindanao is committed to accessible, quality education and has established well-structured scholarship services and policies through the Student Accounting Office to support its diverse student population. This system ensures that deserving students are given opportunities for financial assistance through scholarships and grants. Scholarship services promote academic excellence, leadership, and social responsibility; provide financial support to economically disadvantaged or specially qualified students; and implement fair, transparent, merit-based selection procedures in line with university values and the Operational Procedures Manual (OPM 24.08). This manual serves as the central document that governs the management, implementation, and compliance monitoring of all scholarship and financial aid programs offered by the university. Specifically, it ensures that all requirements for scholarship and discount grants are clearly defined to facilitate the review and approval process.

Scope

This procedures manual applies to all internal scholarship and discounts given to students.

Guiding Principles

Equity and Inclusivity. Scholarships are awarded without discrimination, thereby ensuring equal opportunity for all qualified students regardless of gender, religion, ethnicity, or socioeconomic background.

Merit and Integrity. The selection and retention of scholars are based on academic performance, leadership potential, demonstrated talent, or verified financial need, with strict adherence to high standards of honesty and accountability.

Transparency and Accountability. All scholarship processes, including application, evaluation, and award decisions, are governed by clearly defined policies and are subject to periodic audits and reviews.

Student-Centered Service. Scholarship services are designed to prioritize the welfare, needs, and aspirations of students, while promoting their holistic development and academic success.

Sustainability and Resource Stewardship. Scholarship programs are managed efficiently to ensure sustainability and to maximize benefits for as many deserving students as possible within the limits of available resources.

Excellence and Continuous Improvement. The scholarship system is continuously evaluated and improved to align with best practices, institutional goals, and the evolving needs of students.

Compliance

Through strict adherence to its Operational Procedures Manual (OPM 24.08), the University of Mindanao upholds the integrity and effectiveness of its scholarship programs, ensuring that only eligible and deserving students benefit from these forms of financial aid while promoting a culture of responsibility and excellence. Scholarship applications are processed in accordance with published deadlines and procedures. Grantees must submit accurate documentation, comply with all requirements, and adhere to established deadlines. Selection criteria, as outlined in the manual, are strictly observed to prevent bias or preferential treatment. Grantees are also required to maintain the prescribed academic performance and uphold standards of conduct. Regular monitoring ensures that scholars continue to meet the qualifications for renewal.

Implementation and Review

The Scholarship Section under the Student Accounting Office oversees the implementation of the scholarship manual. The manual is introduced to scholarship coordinators through regular orientations, while students and applicants are informed through handbooks, briefings, and official university platforms. It outlines a standardized workflow for scholarship application, selection, awarding, renewal, and termination, including documentation procedures, validation steps, and approval checkpoints. Regular reports assess the efficiency of implementation. The manual is reviewed annually, particularly in response to changes in university policies, and any proposed revisions must be approved by the Scholarship Policy Committee and university management.

Signed:

(Sgd) GUILLERMO P. TORRES, JR.
University President

Reference

OPM 24.08 – Scholarships and Discounts; November. 29, 2024; Rev. 10